RUNYANKORE ↔ ENGLISH SMART TRANSLATOR

User Guide

Version: 3.0
Live App: https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com
Developer: Nyanzwengye David
Platform: Web (installable as PWA on Android, iOS, Windows, and Desktop)
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1. INTRODUCTION

The **Runyankore ↔ English Smart Translator** is a web-based tool built to preserve and promote the Runyankore language through modern technology.

Live app: https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com

It allows you to:

- Translate between **Runyankore and English** in both directions
- Look up words and phrases with autocomplete
- Use the app **completely offline** after the first load
- Save and revisit translation history
- Listen to pronunciations with built-in text-to-speech
- Install the app like a native application on phone or computer

Free to use, works on any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, Firefox).

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2. GETTING STARTED

2.1 Opening the App

1. Open your browser.
2. Go to: **https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com**
3. On first use you'll see a **consent banner** at the bottom. Click **Accept** — this is remembered on your device.

2.2 First-Load Requirement

- The **first** time you open the app, you need internet.
- After the first successful load, the offline dictionary is saved to your device — the app then works **without internet**.

2.3 Understanding the Layout

Area	Purpose
Header	Word/phrase counts, version badge, admin link, offline indicator
Translation Cards	Runyankore input · Translation Result · English input
Dictionary Section	Search box with autocomplete and results
Footer	Quick links, developer contact, legal pages, Support button

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3. TRANSLATING TEXT

3.1 Runyankore → English

1. Type or paste Runyankore text into the **Runyankore Input** box (left).
2. Click **"Translate to English"**.
3. The result appears in the **Translation Result** card (middle) with a **confidence score**.
4. **Translation Details** below show: original, translation, confidence, direction, source, and time.

3.2 English → Runyankore

1. Type English text into the **English Input** box (right).
2. Click **"Translate to Runyankore"**.
3. Result appears in the middle card.

3.3 Source Icons

- 📱 **Offline** — translation came from the dictionary stored on your device (fast, no internet needed)
- 🌐 **Smart Match** — translation came from the online server (needs internet)

3.4 If a Translation Is Not Found

You'll see:

"Translation not found. Try a different word or check spelling."

Try:

- Checking the spelling (Runyankore spellings can vary)
- Using a shorter form of the word
- Using the dictionary search to find similar words

- Connecting to the internet (Smart Match tries harder)

3.5 Action Buttons on the Result Card

Button	Purpose
Copy	Copy the translation to your clipboard
Save	Save the translation to your history
Speak	Read it aloud (English or Runyankore voice)
Clear ✕	Clear the result area

4. SEARCHING THE DICTIONARY

1. Scroll to the **Runyankore Dictionary** section.
2. Type at least **2 characters** — autocomplete suggestions appear instantly.
3. Click a suggestion **or** press **Enter** / click **Search**.
4. Results show: Runyankore word · English word · Category · Source (📱 / 🌐)

Tips:

- Search works in **both languages** at once.
- Partial words work: typing `"Ora"` suggests `"Oraire ota"`.
- Offline search runs first; if nothing is found and you're online, the server is queried automatically.

Click **Clear** next to the search box to reset.

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5. QUICK PHRASES

Above each Translate button are four **Quick Phrase** buttons.

Runyankore side: Amagara gawe? · Yebare · Oraire ota · Ndi gye

English side: How is your life? · Thank you · Good morning · I am fine

Click any to insert that phrase into the input box instantly.

6. TRANSLATION HISTORY

6.1 Viewing

- Footer → **Quick Links** → **"Translation History"**
- Shows original, translation, direction, confidence, and time.

6.2 Saving

- Translations are saved **automatically** after each success.
- Use the **Save** button on the result card to re-save.
- History is kept **locally on your device** (up to 100 most recent).

6.3 Exporting to PDF

Open History → **"Export to PDF"** → a print-friendly tab opens → use browser **Print → Save as PDF**.

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6.4 Clearing

History modal → **"Clear History"** → confirm. Deletes local history; clears server copy too if online.

7. TEXT-TO-SPEECH

7.1 English

Click the 🔊 icon next to the English input, or **Speak** on the result card when the translation is in English. Uses the best natural English voice available on your device.

7.2 Runyankore

Click the 🔊 icon next to Runyankore input, or **Speak** on a Runyankore result.

Note: Runyankore uses **Swahili voice technology** — the closest available match for accurate Bantu pronunciation. A one-time info note explains this on first use.

7.3 Voice Input (English only)

Click the 🎤 icon next to the English input (if your device supports it), speak, and the text will be inserted and auto-translated. Works best in **Chrome** or **Edge**.

8. OFFLINE MODE

Works **fully offline** after the first load.

8.1 What Works Offline

- ✓ Dictionary search
- ✓ Runyankore ↔ English translation (from local dictionary)
- ✓ Translation history
- ✓ Quick phrases
- ✓ Text-to-speech

8.2 What Needs Internet

- ❖ Smart Match translation
- ❖ Submitting new translations
- ❖ Statistics modal
- ❖ Sending feedback

8.3 Offline Indicator

When you go offline, an **"Offline Mode"** indicator appears at the top. Reconnecting briefly shows **"Back Online"**.

8.4 Getting the Latest Dictionary

1. Connect to the internet.
2. Click the **Refresh** button in the header.
3. The page reloads with the newest dictionary — now cached for offline use.

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9. STATISTICS & VERSION

Click the **version badge** (e.g. `v3.0`) at the top to open Statistics. It shows:

- Dictionary version
- Total offline translations
- Words / phrases / categories counts
- Last build date
- Your online/offline status

The word and phrase counts in the header update automatically.

10. CONTRIBUTING NEW TRANSLATIONS

10.1 Submitting

1. Footer → **Quick Links** → **"Add Translation"**
2. Enter:
   - **Runyankore** word/phrase
   - **English** translation
   - **Type**: Single Word or Phrase
3. Read the important accuracy notice.
4. Tick the confirmation checkbox.
5. Click **Submit Translation**.

10.2 What Happens Next

- Your submission goes to the admin for **review**.
- It **won't appear immediately** — it waits for approval by language experts.

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- Once approved, it becomes part of the public dictionary.

10.3 Requirements

- You must be **online**.
- You must be proficient in both Runyankore and English.
- Only submit translations you're confident are correct — incorrect ones are rejected.

11. FEEDBACK & SUPPORT

11.1 Sending Feedback

Footer → **Quick Links** → **"Send Feedback"**. Fill in:

- Name (optional)
- Email (optional — useful if you want a reply)
- Type: General · Bug · Suggestion · Praise · Question
- Message (**required**)

Click **Send Feedback**.

11.2 Viewing Your Feedback History

Footer → **Quick Links** → **"My Feedback History"** — shows status (Pending / Read / Replied), admin replies, and lets you delete your own entries.

11.3 Supporting the Project

Click the red **"Support This Project"** button in the footer for WhatsApp / Email contact.

Mention *"Runyankore Translator Support"* in your message.

12. INSTALLING AS AN APP (PWA)

12.1 Android / Chrome / Edge

Click the floating **"Install App"** button, **or** use the browser menu → **"Install App"** / **"Add to Home Screen"**.

12.2 iPhone / iPad (Safari)

1. Tap **Share**
2. Scroll → **"Add to Home Screen"**
3. Tap **Add**

12.3 Windows / Desktop

Click the **install icon** in the address bar, **or** use the browser menu → **"Install Runyankore Translator"**.

12.4 Benefits

- App icon on home screen / desktop
- Works offline like a native app
- Faster loading on repeat opens
- Full-screen mode (no browser bars)
- Better sleep management (prevents screen locking during use.

13. TROUBLESHOOTING

App shows old version after update

1. Clear browser **history, cache, cookies, site data** for this domain.
2. Close all app tabs.
3. Reopen: https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com
4. Wait **10–20 seconds** for the new version to load.

Offline dictionary not loading

1. Make sure you're online.
2. Click **Refresh** in the header.
3. Wait for reload, then retry.

"Translation not found"

- Check spelling, try a shorter form, or try dictionary search.
- Connect to internet — Smart Match will try harder.

Text-to-speech not working

- Check device volume.
- Some browsers require a user click before playing audio — click the speaker again.

Voice input not working

- Allow **microphone permission**.
- Works best in Chrome/Edge.
- Make sure no other app is using the mic.

Submitting translation fails

- You must be **online**.
- Check the confirmation checkbox is ticked.

PWA install button missing

- Use the browser menu → "Install App" / "Add to Home Screen".
- On iOS, use **Safari** (Chrome on iOS doesn't support install).

14. PRIVACY & TERMS

By using the translator, you agree to the app's:

- **Terms of Service** — https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com/terms
- **Privacy Policy** — https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com/privacy
- **Software License** — https://runyankoretranslator.pythonanywhere.com/license

What We Collect

- Anonymous usage data (searches — word, direction) to improve the dictionary
- Feedback you submit (name/email are optional)

- No advertising, no third-party tracking

Your Rights

- Delete your own feedback anytime from "My Feedback History"
- Translation history is stored **locally on your device** — clear it anytime

15. CONTACT & CREDITS

Developer: David Nyanzwengye

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Mission: Preserving Runyankore culture through modern technology.

Special thanks to the Runyankore-speaking community whose words, phrases, and corrections continue to improve this dictionary.

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